

ADMINISTRATION, ECONOMY & SOCIETY UNDER THE SULTANATE

SULTANATE THEMATIC CHRONOLOGY → STATE FORMATION AS A → CENTRAL DEPARTMENTS WITH CHRONOLOGY → IQTA FISCAL-MILITARY FLOW → REVENUE AND LOCAL HIERARCHY → ARMY, LOGISTICS AND URBAN

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g4 and all prior artifacts unchanged

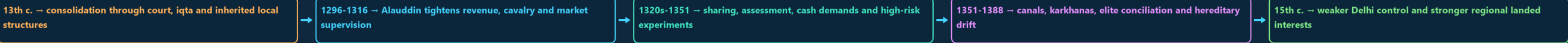
CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 SULTANATE THEMATIC CHRONOLOGY

SULTANATE THEMATIC CHRONOLOGY 13TH C. CONSOLIDATION THROUGH COURT, IQTA AND INHERITED LOCAL STRUCTURES ALAUDDIN TIGHTENS REVENUE, CAVALRY AND MARKET SUPERVISION SHARING, ASSESSMENT, CASH DEMANDS AND HIGH-RISK EXPERIMENTS

CANALS, KARKHANAS, ELITE CONCILIATION AND HEREDITARY DRIFT 15TH C. WEAKER DELHI CONTROL AND STRONGER REGIONAL LANDED INTERESTS



CHRONOLOGY / PHASE	MATERIAL / INSTITUTION	IMPACT / LIMIT
13th c. → consolidation through court, iqta and inherited local structures 1296-1316 → Alauddin tightens revenue, cavalry and market supervision 1320s-1351 → sharing, assessment, cash demands and high-risk experiments	1351-1388 → canals, karkhanas, elite conciliation and hereditary drift 15th c. → weaker Delhi control and stronger regional landed interests - RULE: institutions changed by reign, region, distance and enforcement capacity.	MUST REMEMBER: Iqta, muqti, kharaj, jizya and central diwans must be matched to their precise fiscal-administrative functions.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — RULE: institutions changed by reign, region, distance and enforcement capacity.

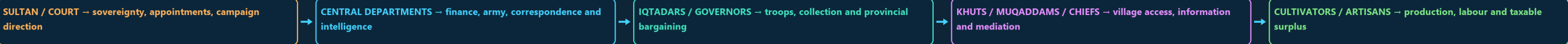
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: institutions changed by reign, region, distance and enforcement capacity.

01

STAGE 01 STATE FORMATION AS A LAYERED NETWORK

STATE FORMATION AS A LAYERED NETWORK SOVEREIGNTY, APPOINTMENTS, CAMPAIGN DIRECTION CENTRAL DEPARTMENTS FINANCE, ARMY, CORRESPONDENCE AND INTELLIGENCE TROOPS, COLLECTION AND PROVINCIAL BARGAINING VILLAGE ACCESS, INFORMATION AND MEDIATION

PRODUCTION, LABOUR AND TAXABLE SURPLUS COERCIVE AT NODES, NEGOTIATED ACROSS THE COUNTRYSIDE.



POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY	EVIDENCE / MECHANISM	DEBATE / LEGACY
- SULTAN / COURT → sovereignty, appointments, campaign direction - CENTRAL DEPARTMENTS → finance, army, correspondence and intelligence	- IQTADARS / GOVERNORS → troops, collection and provincial bargaining - KHUTS / MUQADDAMS / CHIEFS → village access, information and mediation	- CULTIVATORS / ARTISANS → production, labour and taxable surplus - VERDICT: coercive at nodes, negotiated across the countryside.

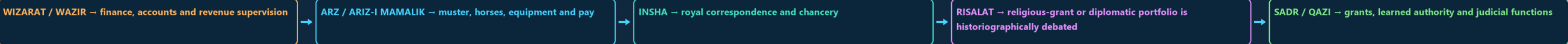
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT: coercive at nodes, negotiated across the countryside.

02

STAGE 02 CENTRAL DEPARTMENTS WITH CHRONOLOGY CAUTION

CENTRAL DEPARTMENTS WITH CHRONOLOGY CAUTION FINANCE, ACCOUNTS AND REVENUE SUPERVISION ARIZ-I MAMALIK MUSTER, HORSES, EQUIPMENT AND PAY ROYAL CORRESPONDENCE AND CHANCERY RELIGIOUS-GRANT OR DIPLOMATIC PORTFOLIO IS HISTORIOGRAPHICALLY DEBATED

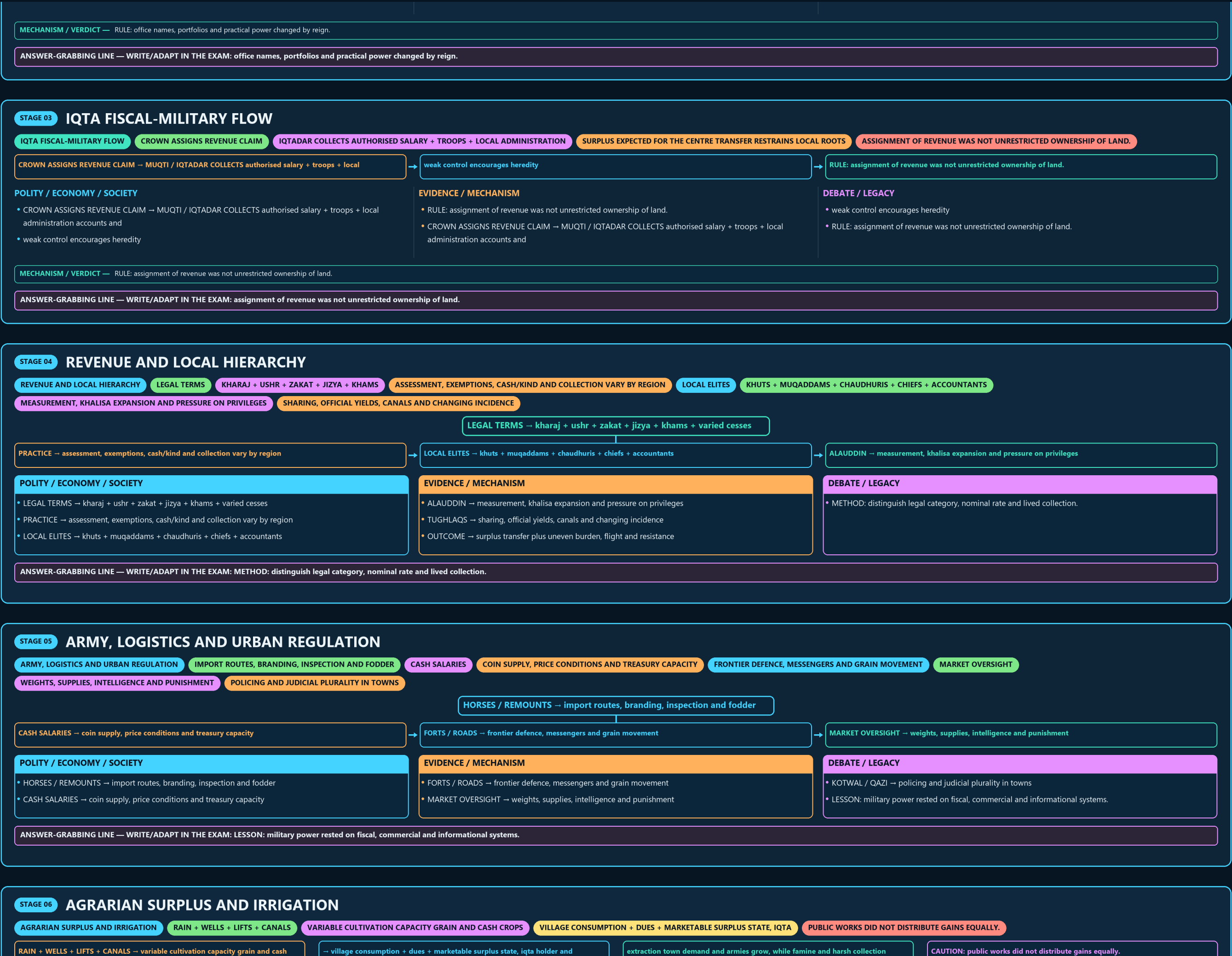
GRANTS, LEARNED AUTHORITY AND JUDICIAL FUNCTIONS INTELLIGENCE, REPORTS AND COMMUNICATION



CHRONOLOGY / PHASE	MATERIAL / INSTITUTION	IMPACT / LIMIT
- WIZARAT / WAZIR → finance, accounts and revenue supervision - ARZ / ARIZ-I MAMALIK → muster, horses, equipment and pay - INSHA → royal correspondence and chancery	- RISALAT → religious-grant or diplomatic portfolio is historiographically debated - SADR / QAZI → grants, learned authority and judicial functions - BARID → intelligence, reports and communication	RULE: office names, portfolios and practical power changed by reign.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — RULE: office names, portfolios and practical power changed by reign.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: office names, portfolios and practical power changed by reign.



06

STAGE 06 AGRARIAN SURPLUS AND IRRIGATION

AGRARIAN SURPLUS AND IRRIGATION

RAIN + WELLS + LIFTS + CANALS

VARIABLE CULTIVATION CAPACITY GRAIN AND CASH CROPS

VILLAGE CONSUMPTION + DUES + MARKETABLE SURPLUS STATE, IQTA

PUBLIC WORKS DID NOT DISTRIBUTE GAINS EQUALLY.

RAIN + WELLS + LIFTS + CANALS → variable cultivation capacity grain and cash crops

→ village consumption + dues + marketable surplus state, iqta holder and intermediaries compete over

extraction town demand and armies grow, while famine and harsh collection expose risk

CAUTION: public works did not distribute gains equally.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- RAIN + WELLS + LIFTS + CANALS → variable cultivation capacity grain and cash crops
- village consumption + dues + marketable surplus state, iqta holder and intermediaries compete over

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- extraction town demand and armies grow, while famine and harsh collection expose risk
- CAUTION: public works did not distribute gains equally.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- RAIN + WELLS + LIFTS + CANALS → variable cultivation capacity grain and cash crops
- village consumption + dues + marketable surplus state, iqta holder and intermediaries compete over

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAUTION: public works did not distribute gains equally.

07

STAGE 07 COINAGE AND MONETISATION EVIDENCE

COINAGE AND MONETISATION EVIDENCE

UNITS AND DENOMINATIONS IN AN EXPANDING MONEY ECONOMY

METAL RANGE, SCARCITY AND REGIONAL VARIATION

AUTHORITY, TITLES AND PUBLIC MONETARY CLAIMS

CASH REVENUE

LINKS COUNTRYSIDE, TREASURY, ARMY AND MERCHANTS

RBI PAGE

OFFICIAL MUSEUM SYNTHESIS, NOT A COMPLETE PRICE OR WELFARE

SOURCE / MATERIAL
TANKA / JITTAL → units and denominations in an expanding money economy
GOLD / SILVER / COPPER → metal range, scarcity and regional variation

METHOD / DEBATE
MINTS / LEGENDS → authority, titles and public monetary claims
CASH REVENUE / SALARY → links countryside, treasury, army and merchants

HISTORICAL RESULT
RBI PAGE → official museum synthesis, not a complete price or welfare series
VERDICT: monetisation expanded unevenly; barter and payment in kind persisted.

SOURCE / MATERIAL

- TANKA / JITTAL → units and denominations in an expanding money economy
- GOLD / SILVER / COPPER → metal range, scarcity and regional variation

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HISTORICAL RESULT

- RBI PAGE → official museum synthesis, not a complete price or welfare series
- VERDICT: monetisation expanded unevenly; barter and payment in kind persisted.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: monetisation expanded unevenly; barter and payment in kind persisted.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: monetisation expanded unevenly; barter and payment in kind persisted.

08

STAGE 08 URBAN CRAFT AND TECHNOLOGY CIRCUIT

URBAN CRAFT AND TECHNOLOGY CIRCUIT

COURT + ARMY + MERCHANT DEMAND

CAMBAY AND SMALLER QASBAS TEXTILES + PAPER + METAL

GREATER OUTPUT AND SPECIALISATION WITHOUT EQUAL GAINS FOR LABOUR.

COURT + ARMY + MERCHANT DEMAND

DELHI / DAULATABAD / MULTAN / CAMBAY and smaller qasbas textiles + paper + metal

+ building crafts + royal karkhanas spinning wheel, carder's bow, improved looms, mortar and water

RESULT: greater output and specialisation without equal gains for labour.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- COURT + ARMY + MERCHANT DEMAND
- DELHI / DAULATABAD / MULTAN / CAMBAY and smaller qasbas textiles + paper + metal + leather

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- + building crafts + royal karkhanas spinning wheel, carder's bow, improved looms, mortar and water lifting
- RESULT: greater output and specialisation without equal gains for labour.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- COURT + ARMY + MERCHANT DEMAND
- DELHI / DAULATABAD / MULTAN / CAMBAY and smaller qasbas textiles + paper + metal + leather

MECHANISM / VERDICT — RESULT: greater output and specialisation without equal gains for labour.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: greater output and specialisation without equal gains for labour.

09

STAGE 09 TRADE, TRANSPORT AND CREDIT

TRADE, TRANSPORT AND CREDIT

VILLAGE PRODUCERS

BANJARAS AND LOCAL MARKETS

INLAND TOWNS

ADVANCES, EXCHANGE AND MERCHANT FINANCE

TRANSFER AND CREDIT ACROSS DISTANCE

BENGAL PORTS

INDIAN OCEAN EXCHANGE AND TEXTILE EXPORTS

VILLAGE PRODUCERS → banjaras and local markets → inland towns

MULTANIS / SAHS / BROKERS → advances, exchange and merchant finance

HUNDIS → transfer and credit across distance

CAMBAY / BENGAL PORTS → Indian Ocean exchange and textile exports

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- VILLAGE PRODUCERS → banjaras and local markets → inland towns
- MULTANIS / SAHS / BROKERS → advances, exchange and merchant finance
- HUNDIS → transfer and credit across distance

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- CAMBAY / BENGAL PORTS → Indian Ocean exchange and textile exports
- HORSE IMPORTS → military demand links coast, merchants and court
- LIMIT: route activity does not prove uniform prosperity or state control.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- CLOSE DISTINCTION: An iqta was not automatically private ownership or hereditary property across every reign and region.

MULTANIS / SAHS / BROKERS → advances, exchange and merchant finance

HUNDIS → transfer and credit across distance

CAMBAY / BENGAL PORTS → Indian Ocean exchange and textile exports

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- VILLAGE PRODUCERS → banjaras and local markets → inland towns
- MULTANIS / SAHS / BROKERS → advances, exchange and merchant finance
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EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

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- HORSE IMPORTS → military demand links coast, merchants and court
- LIMIT: route activity does not prove uniform prosperity or state control.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- CLOSE DISTINCTION: An iqta was not automatically private ownership or hereditary property across every reign and region.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: An iqta was not automatically private ownership or hereditary property across every reign and region.

10

STAGE 10

SOCIAL DIFFERENTIATION WITHOUT STATIC BLOCS

SOCIAL DIFFERENTIATION WITHOUT STATIC BLOCS

MAMLUK/FREEBORN TURK + KHALJI + AFGHAN + TAJIK +

ULAMA + SUFIS + TEMPLES/MOSQUES + PLURAL LOCAL PRACTICE

MERCHANTS + ARTISANS + PEASANTS + INTERMEDIARIES + LABOURERS

OCCUPATIONAL CONTINUITY, ADAPTATION, MOBILITY AND EXCLUSION

MILITARY + DOMESTIC + PRODUCTIVE FORMS; NOT ONE ATLANTIC

ELITE/PROPERTY/HOUSEHOLD AND COMMON LABOUR AGENCY DIFFER

HINDU AND MUSLIM SOCIETIES WERE NEITHER SEALED NOR HOMOGENEOUS

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

ELITES → mamluk/freeborn Turk + Khalji + Afghan + Tajik + Indian Muslim

RELIGIOUS → ulama + Sufis + temples/mosques + plural local practice

ECONOMY → merchants + artisans + peasants + intermediaries + labourers

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

VARNA / JATI → occupational continuity, adaptation, mobility and exclusion

SLAVERY → military + domestic + productive forms; not one Atlantic analogy

GENDER → elite/property/household and common labour agency differ

DEBATE / LEGACY

RULE: Hindu and Muslim societies were neither sealed nor homogeneous blocs.

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Administrative ideals, chronicler prescriptions and uneven local practice must remain analytically separate.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- ELITES → mamluk/freeborn Turk + Khalji + Afghan + Tajik + Indian Muslim
- RELIGIOUS → ulama + Sufis + temples/mosques + plural local practice
- ECONOMY → merchants + artisans + peasants + intermediaries + labourers

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- VARNA / JATI → occupational continuity, adaptation, mobility and exclusion
- SLAVERY → military + domestic + productive forms; not one Atlantic analogy
- GENDER → elite/property/household and common labour agency differ

DEBATE / LEGACY

- RULE: Hindu and Muslim societies were neither sealed nor homogeneous blocs.
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: Administrative ideals, chronicler prescriptions and uneven local practice must remain analytically separate.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — RULE: Hindu and Muslim societies were neither sealed nor homogeneous blocs.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Hindu and Muslim societies were neither sealed nor homogeneous blocs.

11

STAGE 11

TOPIC 07 EVIDENCE AND ANSWER SPINE

TOPIC 07 EVIDENCE AND ANSWER SPINE

CHANGING MILITARY-FISCAL STATE, CENTRALISING IN ASPIRATION

COURT + DEPARTMENTS + IQTA + LOCAL INTERMEDIARIES

AGRARIAN SURPLUS + MONEY + TOWNS + CRAFTS +

LAYERED ELITES, LABOUR, CASTE, COMMUNITY, SLAVERY AND GENDER

CHRONICLERS + TRAVELLERS + COINS + INSCRIPTIONS + MONUMENTS

NEGOTIATED IN PRACTICE, REGIONALLY UNEVEN AND SOCIALLY UNEQUAL.

OPEN → changing military-fiscal state, centralising in aspiration

ADMIN → court + departments + iqta + local intermediaries

ECONOMY → agrarian surplus + money + towns + crafts + trade

SOCIETY → layered elites, labour, caste, community, slavery and gender

METHOD → chroniclers + travellers + coins + inscriptions + monuments

SOURCE / MATERIAL

- OPEN → changing military-fiscal state, centralising in aspiration
- ADMIN → court + departments + iqta + local intermediaries

METHOD / DEBATE

- ECONOMY → agrarian surplus + money + towns + crafts + trade
- SOCIETY → layered elites, labour, caste, community, slavery and gender

HISTORICAL RESULT

- METHOD → chroniclers + travellers + coins + inscriptions + monuments
- CLOSE → negotiated in practice, regionally uneven and socially unequal.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE → negotiated in practice, regionally uneven and socially unequal.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

ADMINISTRATION, ECONOMY & SOCIETY UNDER THE SULTANATE — ADVANCED

1. SNAPSHOT & CORE IDEA

2. KEY CLASSIFICATION

3. STUDY LINKS

4. MUST-KNOW FACTS (PRELIMS)

5. UPSC TRAPS

6. CURRENT LINK

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- Administration, Economy & Society under the Sultanate — ADVANCED
- Mini-timeline
- 1. Snapshot & core idea
- 2. Key classification / data

ADVANCED DEBATE

- 3. Study links
- 4. Must-Know Facts (Prelims)
- 5. UPSC Traps
- 6. Current link

LEGACY / NUANCE

- 7. Mains angles
- + Concept: India as an industrial hub before European dominance
- Historical PVQ Integration (2018-2023)
- Early Turkish rulers largely left land-revenue collection to Hindu chiefs and existing arrangements

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.